

THE EDITOR'S CHAIR LESSON • LESSON 4 OF 6

Teach AI Your Taste



A 45-minute revision and feedback lesson. The hook: your For-You Page didn't guess your taste — you taught it, one like at a time. Students write their taste down in a one-page Taste File, then run the loop that makes AI safe for schoolwork: draft it yourself, get specific feedback, revise it yourself.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Taste File + Editor's Chair worksheet (1 per student)	Optional — works fully unplugged	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Students can explain why vague input gets vague feedback — from an app, an AI, or a person.
- Students can build a **Taste File**: a one-page style guide an editor can actually use.
- Students can run the **editor loop** — draft, seek specific feedback, revise — with the human doing the writing at both ends.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

CCSS ELA W.6.5

ISTE 1.6.b

CCSS ELA SL.6.1

Full standards text, with where each is taught and assessed, in the Teacher Guide.

♥ WARM-UP — THE ALGORITHM KNOWS YOU (6 MIN)

Open with: "**Raise your hand if your feed knows you a little too well.**" Take 2–3 answers to these:

"Two people download the same app on the same day. A month later, one feed is all horror edits and the other is all cooking videos. The app didn't guess. **How did it learn?**"

Land on: every like, skip, rewatch, and follow is a signal. You *taught* it your taste — and the more precisely you signal, the better the feed serves you. Your feed is the proof: it IS your taste, written down in likes and skips.

Bridge: "Here's the flip side: a fresh chat knows nothing about you. It knows nothing about your taste until you teach it. Today you write your taste down on one page — and then you use it to make YOUR OWN writing better."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — GENERIC IN, GENERIC OUT (9 MIN)

- 1 — Generic in, generic out.** Ask an AI "give me feedback on my paragraph" and you get fortune-cookie notes: "add detail," "vary your sentences." True for anyone, useful to no one.
- 2 — The Taste File.** One page: your tone, formats, pet peeves, one "so me" sentence. Your For-You Page for words — hand it to any editor and the notes finally fit YOU.
- 3 — The editor loop. YOU draft → editor gives notes → YOU revise.** Say it plainly: "*AI is your editor, not your ghostwriter.*"

Model the difference on the board: "Make it more interesting" (generic) vs. "Your taste file says *funny and blunt* — sentence 2 sounds like a homework robot. Say it like you'd text it" (taste-file note).

ACTIVITY 1 — BUILD YOUR TASTE FILE (12 MIN)

1. Solo on worksheet page 1: circle tone words, pick formats, write two pet peeves, then **So Me / Not Me** — one sentence in their real voice, the same sentence in a voice that isn't.
2. Circulate and push for specifics: "lowkey" beats "good"; "don't make me sound like a textbook" beats "be nice."
3. Minute 10: two volunteers read a So Me sentence — the class hears how different real taste sounds.

ACTIVITY 2 — THE EDITOR'S CHAIR (14 MIN)

1. **Draft (5 min):** Solo, worksheet page 2 — 3–4 sentences: an About Me for a channel or profile page they'd actually make. No AI, no partner.
2. **Editor's notes (4 min):** Pairs swap drafts AND taste files. The partner plays the AI editor: exactly **2 notes**, each pointing at a numbered taste-file section, no rewriting. *With devices:* students give a real AI their taste file and draft using the copy-ready prompt (Teacher Guide, p.2) and it returns 2 notes.
3. **Revise (5 min):** Students rewrite their own draft and star (*) every change. The editor never touches the draft.

EXIT TICKET (4 MIN)

Bottom of worksheet page 2: students name **one revision they made** and explain **why it fits their taste file**.

DIFFERENTIATION

- **Support:** Extra tone words and editor sentence frames (Teacher Guide, p.2).
- **Extension:** Write the anti-taste-file — three notes for the voice you never want.
- **ELL:** Tone words double as vocabulary support; taste files may include home-language words.
- **No-device classrooms:** Built in — the partner IS the AI, and the taste file is all the "training data" they get.